

MARKET SURVEY:

Green Power Backup Solutions will be the Next Big Thing in India



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With focus steadily increasing on renewable energy, the uninterrupted power supply (UPS) and inverter industry is slowly coming up with systems that are compatible with various renewable energy sources. Manufacturers are also investing on creating products that are energy-efficient, highly reliable and robustly designed with a lower total cost of ownership. Let us take a look at the drivers of the industrial power backup industry, products in demand, market trends, government policies and industry experts' views on the future of this segment.

Growth factors

The foremost and primary driver of industrial UPSes and inverters is severe power deficit and the consequent frequent power cuts across the nation. Unpredictable power cuts have become a major concern for the corporate sector, feels Moumita Mukherjee, research analyst, Netscribes. She says, "Currently, dedicated power grids to meet domestic and industrial power needs do not exist in India, as a result of

which some key segments like e-commerce and data centres rely completely on uninterrupted power backup."

It would be fair to state that UPSes and inverters have a good market share in India because of the non-availability of a strong grid system. UPSes are required in offices where computers or servers are stationed and uninterrupted power is needed. "If computers and servers go down for even a minute, it creates a lot of problems for organisations dependent on these," says R. Sivarajan, R&D head, Su-Kam. He adds, "The reason for UPSes to be used for high-priority applications is because there is no transfer time required." It is also advantageous for internal lighting loads, fans, coffee machines and other appliances.

Anindya Das, industry manager, Energy & Environment Practice, Frost & Sullivan, says, "Sizeable demand from information technology (IT)/information technology enabled services (ITeS), banking, financial services and insurance (BFSI), government, infrastructure, healthcare, education and manufacturing sectors are driving the UPS market in India." Also, almost every business is connected with the Internet. A lot of trading activities also happen via the Internet.

"Servers host all data and if it is not backed up by UPS, it puts the data at risk," says Sivarajan. "From small-scale entrepreneurs to large multinationals and conglomerates, it is very important that all corporates having critical data hosted on servers must be protected by UPS," he adds.

In sectors like IT/ITeS and BFSI, investment in power backup systems comes from major corporate consumers like TCS, Cognizant and Tech Mahindra, informs Chandrashekhar Prakash Rao, sales director, Secure Power for Industry & Infrastructure, Schneider Electric. These require UPS and inverter systems for their enormous campus-

